

Section 1:

Introduction and Early Life:

Hosea Williams was an influential person in the Civil Rights movement and person among the black community

1. Hosea Williams was born on January 5th 1926 in Attapulgus, Georgia
2. He had two blind parents who both died. His mother died by giving birth to his younger sister
3. As a result of this, the two children had to live with their grandparents on their farm
4. At the age of 14 Hosea and his sister had to leave the farm or else they would be killed or lynched by a mob of white people for befriending a little white girl
 - a. They went to Tallahassee Florida where Hosea got various jobs to support him and his sister
5. Then later they went back home to run the farm, and hosea was unsuccessful
6. Williams later joined the US army in the arrival of world war 2
 - a. He served in an all black unit
 - b. He got wounded during battle in germany and was sent to england for a year of recovery for the military
 - i. He was sent home with the decoration of the Military order of the Purple Heart
 1. This is an award given to combat wounded soldiers

Section 2:

Education and Jobs (early life pt 2.)

1. After recovering from his combat wounds he completed high school and enrolled in Morris Brown College (Atlanta) where he earned a bachelor's degree in Chemistry
2. Later earned a Master's Degree from Atlanta University
3. In the early 1950's Hosea worked as a research chemist for the US department of agriculture
4. He also became a minister
5. Married Juanita Terry
 - a. 9 children in total
 1. Had 5 children of their own and adopted 4 more children
2. He was elected to a term on the Atlanta City Council (1985- 1990)
3. He ran for a senate seat but was unsuccessful
4. He served as a county commissioner 1990-1994
5. Hosea Williams founded the Hosea Feed the Hungry and Homeless Food international aid organization in 1971
6. Hosea has donated Billions of dollars of food, medical aid and educational supplies to recipients in Georgia, Uganda, the Philippines and the Ivory Coast

Section 3:

1. Became involved in 1952
2. Motivated to join the NAACP after he was nearly killed after using an all white water fountain
3. Joined the Southern Christian Leadership Conference in 1964
4. He was one of MLK's most trusted officers in the SCLC
5. William conducted black voter registrations in 1964
6. He played a leadership role in the March to Montgomery
 - a. Known as Bloody Sunday
 - i. Because the march was stopped by police brutalities
 - ii. They were tear-gassed, called racial slurs, and brutally beaten
 - iii. The rising racial tensions finally bubbled over into bloodshed in the nearby town of Marion on February 18, 1965, when state troopers clubbed protestors and fatally shot 26-year-old Jimmie Lee Jackson, an African American demonstrator trying to protect his mother, who was being struck by police.
7. The event prompted President Johnson to pass the Voting Rights Act
8. In 1965, King appointed Williams to president of the SCLC's Summer Community Organization and Political Education
9. In 1987, Hosea Williams was responsible for leading Georgia's largest civil rights march
 - a. 200,000 protesters withstood racial slurs
10. In 1996, Williams led a march protesting the confederate symbol on Georgia's flag

● ***What were his or her major contributions to the civil rights struggle?***

- Hosea was responsible for leading Georgia's biggest civil rights march
 - Around 20,000 protesters
 - They resisted racial slurs and physical violence from white supremacy groups in Forsyth County (an all white area)
- He also led a march in 1996 to Georgia's state capitol to protest the confederate symbol on the state flag
- Was also part of the Freedom Summer voter registration campaign and was arrested around 124 times.
- Alongside John Lewis, on march 7th 1965, Hosea led the Selma to Montgomery march which is a famous even that was on television across the nation.
 - This march demanded that blacks have the right to vote in state PEACEFULLY
 - Anyone who was an peaceful marcher (all of them who kneeled down to pray had state troopers who used nightsticks and tear gas on them.

- This was in attempt to stop the march
 - Became known as Bloody Sunday and Hosea was knocked unconscious and went to the hospital
- He died of kidney cancer on November 16th 2000

- Hosea Williams should be remembered as an influential and important person in the civil rights movement and in history
 - He made many contributions not only to the movement but to life in general
- He was apart of many civil rights protests that led to the bettering of black lives
- He risked his life to make other people's lives better
- I believe that he changed black lives in the future